Lab 2: Reflections

Digital Gift Card & Loyalty Point Exchange

Sprint Outcome

Both sprints were completed in full. Nothing was pushed to a later sprint, so scope was estimated accurately at the story level; this reflects small, well-scoped stories rather than a claim of perfect real-world estimation.

Burndown Chart

Both burndown charts show a near-vertical drop instead of a gradual daily decline. This is expected: the sprints were simulated in a few minutes rather than over the actual 1–2 week sprint window, so Jira recorded all status changes on a single day. It reflects the simulation method, not real sprint pacing.

Prioritization

Ranking by dependency (account linking and conversion before redemption and validation) made backlog ordering straightforward. Highest-priority stories aligned with the FRs marked High in the Lab 1 requirements table, which suggests the priority field was applied consistently rather than arbitrarily.

Learnings & Takeaways

- Structuring the backlog around dependencies (linking -> conversion -> redemption -> validation) made prioritization almost automatic — once the flow was mapped out, ranking wasn't a guessing game.
- Tracing every story back to a specific FR/NFR from the Lab 1 requirements table kept the backlog grounded – nothing was invented, and each story could be justified by pointing to a specific requirement.
- Splitting Sprint 1 (foundation: linking, conversion, encryption) from Sprint 2 (redemption, validation) reinforced how architecture and backlog planning connect – building the pieces users depend on first, before the pieces that depend on them.
- Assigning story points using Fibonacci gave a quick, consistent way to gauge relative effort across very different types of work (a UI balance view vs. a checksum/locking mechanism), without needing exact time estimates.
- Running two full sprints end-to-end (creation -> prioritization -> execution -> completion) made the Scrum cycle concrete instead of theoretical – seeing a "Complete Sprint" screen made the process click in a way just reading about Scrum doesn't.